

01-product-brief

WorkTape Product Brief

One-Line Description

WorkTape turns a screen recording of repetitive human work into a working internal web app.

Problem

Small businesses often run important workflows through WhatsApp, spreadsheets, payment notes, and manual follow-ups. The person doing the work understands the process, but they usually cannot write a software spec, PRD, database schema, or app requirements document.

That means useful internal tools do not get built, even when the workflow is repeated every day.

Insight

The strongest input is not a prompt. It is the work itself.

WorkTape treats a screen recording as the software spec. A user performs a manual workflow once, and WorkTape observes the steps, identifies the business objects, asks a few clarifying questions, and turns the workflow into a focused internal tool.

Target User

- Coaching institute admins

- Admissions teams
- Small business owners
- Operations assistants
- Local service businesses using WhatsApp and spreadsheets
- Non-technical teams who can show their work but cannot spec software

Wednesday MVP Scope

The Day 3 MVP focuses on one workflow:

WhatsApp/lead management plus spreadsheet tracking -> admissions CRM.

The MVP demonstrates the core transformation:

1. Upload or select a workflow recording.
2. Extract frames from the recording.
3. Analyze the frames with an OpenAI vision-capable model.
4. Produce structured workflow JSON.
5. Ask clarifying questions.
6. Create a final app spec.
7. Render a usable internal CRM from the spec.

What Works Today

- Next.js frontend and API backend.
- Upload/select recording flow.
- ffmpeg-based frame extraction.
- OpenAI Responses API route for workflow analysis.
- Structured WorkflowSpec JSON contract.
- Clarifying questions and final spec creation.
- Spec-to-app mapping screen.
- Generated admissions tool rendered from the spec.
- Working form, records table, status controls, WhatsApp message templates, copy actions, and CSV export.

Honest Boundaries

- Real: frontend flow, backend route, frame extraction, live AI path with configured API key, structured spec validation, and spec-driven CRM

rendering.

- Fallback: saved sample analysis for deterministic demo reliability when live AI is slow or unavailable.
- Not included yet: WhatsApp API integration, production auth, broad arbitrary workflow support, public deployment, and runtime Codex SDK integration.

Why This Matters

Most software starts from written requirements. WorkTape explores a different starting point: observed human labor.

If the product works, non-technical operators can turn repeated manual work into useful internal software without first learning how to write specs.